PRACTICE EXAM 26 / EXAM SET 04

Domain 5: Administrative Assisting

12 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

> **SCENARIO** An outside report contains two sheets printed on both sides, for four numbered pages total. After scanning, the correct patient's electronic document contains only pages 1 and 3. The scanner was set to single-sided capture. Office policy requires complete, legible documents and a controlled replacement of incomplete scans.

Which action corrects the document-acquisition problem?

A. Rescan both sides, verify all four pages, and replace the incomplete scan through the approved workflow.

B. Rename the existing scan as a four-page report without changing its contents.

C. Upload pages 1 and 3 again so the document contains four scanned pages.

D. File the existing scan because the patient identifiers on the first page are correct.

Q02 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

> **SCENARIO** A patient will attend a telehealth visit from a location one hour behind the clinic. The confirmed invitation lists the same appointment as 3:00 p.m. clinic time and 2:00 p.m. patient-local time. The patient's personal calendar displays 3:00 p.m. because it is set to the clinic's time zone. The patient asks when to join from home.

Which instruction preserves the confirmed appointment time?

A. Join at 3:00 p.m. patient-local time because that is what the personal calendar shows.

B. Join at 4:00 p.m. patient-local time to account for the time-zone difference.

C. Join at 2:00 p.m. patient-local time, matching 3:00 p.m. at the clinic.

D. Join at 1:00 p.m. patient-local time to move the appointment one additional hour earlier.

Q03 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

SCENARIO An authorization request has been submitted for a nonurgent service. The payer portal lists its status as "Pending: signed clinical note required." The requested signed note is now available in the chart. The payer identifies the existing request number and an approved attachment channel; office policy assigns submission to the authorization coordinator.

Which action best advances this existing request?

A. Open a second request and leave the existing pending request active.
B. Route the signed note and existing request number to the coordinator for attachment and follow-up.
C. Mark the service approved because the signed note is now available.
D. Tell the patient the payer denied the request and that no further review is available.

Q04 | Coding Billing and Payments

SCENARIO A claim was submitted 12 days ago. The payer portal says "Accepted for processing; review pending," with no payment decision. The payer's supplied instructions allow 30 days for routine processing and direct offices to monitor the existing claim during that period unless additional information is requested. No information request has been issued.

How should the assistant handle this claim today?

A. Post the full insurer payment because acceptance means the claim has been paid.
B. Submit the same claim again to create a second opportunity for payment.
C. Transfer the entire charge to the patient because no payment has arrived.
D. Record the pending status and continue monitoring the existing claim under the stated instructions.

Q05 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

SCENARIO The supplier recalls adhesive barcode-label rolls from lot L410 because the labels may detach. The clinic has rolls from lots L410 and L401 of the same product. The notice identifies only L410, and office policy requires affected stock to be separated from available supplies, logged, and reported to the purchasing lead.

Which inventory action matches the notice and policy?

A. Separate and log the L410 rolls, report them, and retain unaffected L401 stock as available.
B. Separate the L401 rolls because that lot number contains the same digits.
C. Keep both lots available because they are the same type of office supply.
D. Remove both lots from the inventory record without documenting what was affected.

Q06 | Coding Billing and Payments

SCENARIO A settled card batch contains $420 in patient payments and $35 in separately documented patient refunds. The processor deducts an $8 practice processing fee from that same batch, producing the bank deposit. Office policy records payments and refunds at their full amounts and records the fee as a practice expense.

Which bank deposit and fee treatment reconcile this batch?

A. $385 deposited; reduce patient payment credits by $8 to record the fee.
B. $377 deposited; retain the full payment and refund amounts and record an $8 practice expense.
C. $412 deposited; record the refunds as an expense already included in the fee.
D. $463 deposited; add the refunds and fee to the recorded patient payment total.

Q07 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

SCENARIO A provider will be away next Tuesday afternoon. The office manager has approved blocking that session and contacting the four patients already booked to offer replacement visits. A recurring template still displays the session as available, so online scheduling could add more patients. The assistant is authorized to update that template for the approved absence.

Which action best carries out the scheduling change?

A. Keep the template open and begin calling the four booked patients.
B. Delete the session and all four appointments without retaining a follow-up list.
C. Block further booking for the approved session and track rescheduling of the four affected patients.
D. Move the four patients to arbitrary openings and notify them after the changes are finalized.

Q08 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

Which plan resource lists the prescription drugs covered under its prescription benefit?

A. The provider directory.
B. The formulary.
C. The explanation of benefits.
D. The referral tracking log.

Q09 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

SCENARIO A routine office letter is returned as undeliverable because the apartment number was missing. The patient has now verified the complete current mailing address through the office's established identity-verification process. Office policy requires updating the demographic record before regenerating correspondence and retaining a note of the returned mailing.

How should the assistant correct this correspondence problem?

A. Resend the original letter without changing its address.

B. Change only the paper envelope and leave the demographic record incomplete.

C. Delete the returned-mail note because the patient has now supplied the missing detail.

D. Update the verified address, record the returned mailing, and regenerate the letter with the complete address.

Q10 | Coding Billing and Payments

Which accounting term describes amounts still owed to the practice for services it has already provided?

A. Accounts receivable.

B. Accounts payable.

C. Petty cash.

D. Contractual adjustments.

Q11 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

SCENARIO A patient cancels a routine office procedure scheduled for tomorrow. The appointment and a linked procedure-room reservation are separate entries in the scheduling system. Office policy requires canceling both entries, documenting the patient's cancellation, and placing a rescheduling task in the designated queue. The assistant is authorized to perform those scheduling actions.

Which action completes this cancellation workflow?

A. Cancel the appointment but keep the linked room reservation active.

B. Release the room reservation but leave the appointment booked.

C. Cancel both scheduling entries, document the request, and create the rescheduling task.

D. Mark the appointment completed and remove the procedure order from the chart.

Q12 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

SCENARIO A patient wants to establish care with Dr. Brown, but the verified HMO enrollment record still lists Dr. Adams as the selected primary care provider. The plan's written instructions require a member-requested PCP change and confirmation of its effective date before treating Dr. Brown as the selected PCP for routine benefit processing. The patient asks the assistant for help with that change.

Which administrative action follows the plan instructions?

A. Edit the clinic record to show Dr. Brown and treat that edit as the plan's confirmation.

B. Help the patient use the plan's PCP-change process and verify the confirmed effective date.

C. Tell the patient that scheduling a visit automatically changes the selected PCP.

D. Submit the routine visit under Dr. Adams' identity while Dr. Brown provides the service.

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

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01 A	02 C	03 B	04 D	05 A	06 B
07 C	08 B	09 D	10 A	11 C	12 B

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: A

Rescan both sides, verify all four pages, and replace the incomplete scan through the approved workflow.

Single-sided capture omitted the backs of the two sheets, so the assistant should rescan both sides and verify pages 1 through 4. The approved replacement process then corrects the incomplete document. Correct identifiers do not compensate for missing report pages.

Q02 | Correct answer: C

Join at 2:00 p.m. patient-local time, matching 3:00 p.m. at the clinic.

The invitation already expresses the same appointment in both time zones: 3:00 p.m. at the clinic equals 2:00 p.m. where the patient will be. The assistant should confirm that local time and help the patient recognize the calendar display setting. Joining at 3:00 p.m. locally would be one hour late.

Q03 | Correct answer: B

Route the signed note and existing request number to the coordinator for attachment and follow-up.

The request is awaiting a specific document, so attaching that note to the existing request addresses the stated deficiency. The assistant should route the material to the designated coordinator and track the response. A pending request is neither an approval nor a denial, and a duplicate request does not complete the original one.

Q04 | Correct answer: D

Record the pending status and continue monitoring the existing claim under the stated instructions.

The claim is within the payer's supplied processing window and has not yet been adjudicated. The assistant should document its status and monitor it rather than post an unsupported payment or send a duplicate claim. Acceptance for processing establishes receipt into the workflow, not a payment decision.

Q05 | Correct answer: A

Separate and log the L410 rolls, report them, and retain unaffected L401 stock as available.

The lot number identifies the affected stock, so L410 rolls should be separated, logged, and reported. The notice does not identify L401 as affected. Matching only the product name or rearranging the lot digits would fail to apply the supplier's specific tracking information.

Q06 | Correct answer: B

$377 deposited; retain the full payment and refund amounts and record an $8 practice expense.

The net deposit is $420 - $35 - $8 = $377. The separate $8 processing fee is a practice expense under the supplied policy; it does not reduce the credit for a patient's actual payment. The reconciliation must account for both the refunds and the fee, not just one of them.

Q07 | Correct answer: C

Block further booking for the approved session and track rescheduling of the four affected patients.

Blocking the approved absence prevents additional bookings while the existing patients are offered replacement visits. Tracking all four affected appointments keeps the rescheduling work visible. Calling patients while leaving the template open could allow the same scheduling problem to grow.

Q08 | Correct answer: B

The formulary.

A formulary is the plan's list of covered prescription drugs. It may also identify drug tiers and coverage conditions, which should be checked for the specific medication. A provider directory lists participating clinicians, while an explanation of benefits describes processing of a claim.

Q09 | Correct answer: D

Update the verified address, record the returned mailing, and regenerate the letter with the complete address.

Updating the source demographic record prevents the same omission from appearing in future correspondence. The assistant should also retain the required returned-mail note and regenerate the letter using the verified address. Fixing only one envelope would leave the underlying office data incomplete.

Q10 | Correct answer: A

Accounts receivable.

Accounts receivable represents amounts owed to the practice, such as unpaid patient or payer balances for provided services. Accounts payable represents amounts the practice owes to others. Petty cash is money kept for small office purchases, while contractual adjustments reduce charges according to applicable agreements.

Q11 | Correct answer: C

Cancel both scheduling entries, document the request, and create the rescheduling task.

Both the patient appointment and the linked room reservation must be canceled to reflect the request and free the reserved capacity. The stated policy also requires documentation and a rescheduling task. Canceling scheduling entries does not by itself authorize deleting the provider's procedure order or recording a completed visit.

Q12 | Correct answer: B

Help the patient use the plan's PCP-change process and verify the confirmed effective date.

The selected PCP is a plan enrollment designation, and the supplied instructions require the member's change request plus confirmation of when it takes effect. The assistant can help the patient navigate that process and document the verified result. Updating the clinic's local record or booking a visit does not establish the payer's effective designation.

End of Practice Exam